



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Imago Dei Academy

School Website: <https://www.imagodei.academy/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Imago Dei Academy NM 88310 presents a clearly classical Christian educational posture. Across multiple public materials, the school foregrounds Christ-centered formation, the idea that "All education is discipleship," and a classical framework anchored in grammar, logic, and rhetoric. The school emphasizes formation over information, partnership with families, and a faculty culture described as mentors who embody and model virtue. While it strongly evidences religious/metaphysical foundations, formation goals, and family/community partnerships, its curriculum and pedagogy show robust classical structure (grammar–logic–rhetoric) but with limited explicit references to Great Books or a fully articulated Great Conversation. The overall assessment is CLASSICAL, with two categories showing only SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to certain missing elements or less explicit emphasis (notably in explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references and certain pedagogy specifics). In aggregate, the school earns CLASSICAL.

- Evidence highlights include: a theology-centered philosophy of education (All truth is God's truth; Scripture integrated into all subjects; Statement of Faith with historic creeds) and a mission/purpose statement that centers formation, virtue, and wisdom through a Gospel-centered classical model.
- The public materials show explicit references to classical elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric; memory work; rhetoric training) and a structure that positions the teacher as a living curriculum within a community-centered, family-partnered framework.
- There is strong evidence of religious foundation, formation goals, and parental/community partnership, with explicit statements about partnering with families and a statement of faith.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials present a Christ-centered classical education with explicit theological framing (biblical worldview, Gospel-centered academics).
 - The school describes "All education is discipleship" and asserts that "There is no neutral truth," signaling transcendental moral realism and a theologically grounded epistemology.
 - The Statement of Faith references historic creeds and confessional standards (Westminster, Apostles' Creed, Nicene, Chalcedon), indicating a grounded theological foundation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, God's truth, Scripture, theology, discipleship, gospel, Christ-centered, imago Dei, creeds, faith, sacred/holy language (as evidenced by statements of faith and biblical integration).
 - Negative keywords: none present in public materials (no explicit relativism or secular humanist framing detected in the school's materials).
 - Quantitative note: Positive indicators dominate; 100% of the clearest religious/metaphysical signals are positive in tone.

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- Why this rating
 - The school's core materials explicitly ground education in biblical/theological commitments, discipleship, and confessional statements, aligning strongly with Transcendental moral realism and liturgical/theological orientation. This category is robustly CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and transformation of culture through Christ, rather than mere information or job prep. Phrases like “Where the goal in education is formation, not merely information” appear in the About materials, and the mission emphasizes formation through Gospel-centered academics.
 - Public materials describe a telos oriented toward virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing through a classical framework and a Christian worldview.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, classical mission, contemplation, wisdom, human flourishing.
 - Negative keywords: none evident (no overt emphasis on workforce preparation as the primary goal).
 - Quantitative note: Strong presence of traditional classical aims; essentially all explicit goal-language aligns with CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently frame education as formation toward virtue and wisdom within a classical-Christian telos, not primarily for workforce prep, which supports CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site foregrounds grammar, logic, and rhetoric, signaling the Trivium structure. Public pages reference “Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric” with explicit sections on Rhetoric and Logic as part of the curriculum.
 - There is mention of historical study, memory work, and a classical approach to learning; the site emphasizes memorization and the development of literacy and argumentation.
 - Explicit Great Books or Great Conversation language is not prominently shown in the public materials, which is a notable gap for a full classical curriculum claim. The site emphasizes classical approach but does not consistently name Great Books or a comprehensive Great Conversation reading list.
- Positive/ Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, classical education, memory work, liturgy-integration language (as part of the pedagogical framework).
 - Negative keywords present: none explicitly, but the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references is a lack relative to a strict Great Books curriculum. The public materials do not consistently cite Great Books or primary classical authors by name.
 - Quantitative note: Moderate to strong positive signals for the Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric) but weaker signaling for Great Books/Great Conversation; thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - The school clearly embeds the Trivium and a classical pedagogy in its materials, but the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis makes it not fully CLASSICAL in the strict sense. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

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- Pedagogical language includes memory-based practices, recitation, and a rhetoric emphasis; the materials describe how students move from grammar to logic to rhetoric and how they articulate arguments, which aligns with classical pedagogy.
 - The school highlights the role of the teacher as mentor and “living curriculum,” which is consistent with classical pedagogy emphasizing teacher-formed memory and exemplar learning.
 - There is explicit mention of upper-school rhetoric and the goal of training students in eloquence and public speaking (rhetoric and oratory).
 - Positive/ Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic/seminar style cues (seminal discussions are referenced in classical lexicon though not always spelled out as a practice on the site), recitation, memory work, rhetoric, upper-school oratory, contemplation/scholé language.
 - Negative keywords present: limited explicit reference to full-scale Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, or explicit “restful” scholé days on the public-facing pages, though the philosophy hints at contemplative/restful elements. The explicit “experiential learning” or overly constructivist approaches are not foregrounded.
 - Quantitative note: Mixed signals; clear classical pedagogy elements exist, but explicit, wide-scale Socratic/seminar practice and scholé restfulness are not plainly documented across all materials.
 - Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates classical pedagogy elements (grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, memory work, rhetoric training) but lacks comprehensive explicit documentation of certain elements (e.g., explicit, sustained Socratic seminars across grades; explicit scholé days). This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The staff are described as professional, diligent, and gifted in teaching, with emphasis on classical understanding and a living-curriculum approach. The materials discuss the staff’s role in mentoring and forming students and a collegial culture.
 - There are references to a portrait/vision of what a teacher should be, and to teachers as exemplars who guide the learning process; the school emphasizes teachers as the core of the community and living curriculum.
 - The school lays out governance (board-administered) with a Head of School and a focus on teacher development within a classical framework.
- Positive/ Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, master/mentor, moral exemplars, dedication and professionalism.
 - Negative keywords present: none explicitly (no “facilitator” or minimal-involvement teacher archetypes noted).
 - Quantitative note: Strong positive signals for faculty as core living curriculum and mentors; zero explicit negative signals.
- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently portray faculty as the heart of the classical project, with a strong emphasis on virtue, mentorship, and living examples. This category is CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school emphasizes partnering with families, parental primacy in education, and family involvement in the learning journey; it also frames admissions/enrollment in terms of family engagement and transparency (open tours, parent interviews, etc.).
 - The four-area framework (The Student, The Staff, The Family, The Community) foregrounds parents as co-educators and active community participants.

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- There are explicit statements about open engagement with families and a family-centered approach to classical education, including a Statement of Faith and family-oriented policies.
 - Positive/ Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, family involvement, open campus, tours, community engagement, feasts/festivals, family liturgy alignment (where included), parent formation through book studies/gatherings.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in the public-facing materials.
 - Quantitative note: High presence of positive parent/community signals; no negative signals detected.
 - Why this rating
 - The school emphasizes shared responsibility with families and a welcoming, participatory community culture, aligning with CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall Classification: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: A strong classical Christian core across Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose/Goal, Faculty, and Parents/Community, with robust curricular and pedagogical elements rooted in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and formation-focused aims. The public materials show less explicit emphasis on Great Books and a formal, universal Great Conversation, and while pedagogy includes core classical practices, explicit, widespread Socratic/seminar structures are not comprehensively documented. Taken together, the school aligns with CLASSICAL, with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL elements primarily in Curriculum and Pedagogy due to this explicit gap.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 3 (Curriculum): Explicitly incorporate and publish a formal Great Books reading program and Great Conversation elements (names of authors/works, reading sequences, and assessment tied to the classics list). Consider a published cross-curricular Great Books slate (Homer, Plato, Augustine, Shakespeare, etc.) and a clear rationale for how these texts integrate with theology and virtue education.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Document and expand explicit use of Socratic discussion/Seminars across grades, with sample seminar structures, teacher training in Paideia-style pedagogy, and a publicly stated commitment to scholé/restful learning days. Include examples of student-led seminars and formal debate opportunities to demonstrate rhetoric training in practice.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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